

The Girl from Ipanema

Antonio Carlos Jobim · F major / G $\flat$ major bridge · $\approx$ 130 BPM · Bossa Nova

4 Weeks · 60 min/session · Guitar + Piano tracks · Ch.5–6 Plogger

S1

PLOGGER

Ch.5 Lap Map
Ch.6 Fifths

10 min

S2

INTEGRATED

Melody + Rhythm
+ Voicings

18 min

S3

SONG

Ipanema verse
+ bridge

14 min

S4

JAMMING

Free play
+ groove

10 min

S5

SYNTHESIZER

Connect +
name it

8 min

ANCHOR SONG — SPRINT 3

The Girl from Ipanema

Antonio Carlos Jobim · 1962 · Bossa Nova standard

VERSE KEY

F major

BRIDGE KEY

G $\flat$ major

TEMPO

$\approx$ 130 BPM

Verse chords: Fmaj7 (4 bars) → G7 (2 bars) → Gm7–C7 (2 bars)

Bridge: G $\flat$ maj7 (4 bars) → B7 (2 bars) → F $\sharp$ m7–D7 (2 bars) → Gm7–C7

NON-NEGOTIABLES — EVERY SESSION

- Hear before you play — sing the phrase first
- Sing before you play — voice the shape aloud
- Name what you feel, then name what you hear

DEFINITION OF DONE — SPRINT 3

☐ Verse + bridge on both instruments at 100 BPM

☐ Can state F–C–G–D–A–E–B fifths ordering aloud

☐ Can analyze 5 Key Notes in any 8-bar melody

Read these summaries before you pick up your instrument. Understanding the concept in words first makes the physical practice 3× faster.

MUSICAL OS · PLOGGER CH.5-6

Ch.5 Lap Map — Your Hand Is the Keyboard

Place your left hand palm-down on your lap. Your five fingers represent the five white keys in any pentachord position; the gaps between them represent black keys. This is the **Lap Map** — a portable, always-available keyboard simulator.

There are four tetrachord types. A **tetrachord** is a group of four notes spanning a perfect 4th. The four types differ only in where the half-step sits: **Ionian** (T-T-S — e.g., F G A B $\flat$), **Dorian** (T-S-T — e.g., G A B $\flat$ C), **Phrygian** (S-T-T — e.g., E F G A), **Lydian** (T-T-T — e.g., F G A B). Sprint 3 focuses on Ionian and Dorian because Ipanema lives in F Ionian and uses Gm (Dorian flavor) in the changes.

Ch.6 Pythagorean Ordering of Fifths — F C G D A E B

The sequence **F – C – G – D – A – E – B** is produced by stacking perfect 5ths. Each step adds one sharp (or removes one flat). Adjacent keys in this chain share 6 of their 7 notes — meaning moving from F major to C major, you only change one note (B $\flat$ → B). This is why key changes along the chain of fifths feel smooth.

Mode brightness tracks position: keys to the right of F (C, G...) are brighter (more sharps); keys to the left (B $\flat$, E $\flat$...) are darker. Ipanema's bridge moves to G $\flat$ — the *opposite* direction from F on the chain, creating the dreamy half-step disorientation that defines the tune.

MELODY CHAMBER · 5 KEY NOTES + TINY TENSION ARC

5 Key Notes Framework

Every melody can be analyzed by finding five structural notes: **First** (how does it launch?), **Last** (where does it land?), **Highest** (the peak — often the emotional climax), **Longest** (duration amplifies zone — the held note declares its zone loudly), **Beat-1 Notes** (downbeat notes carry harmonic weight). In Ipanema's verse, the melody opens on A (the major 3rd of Fmaj7 — Zone 1), rises to its highest note on the word "watch," and consistently lands on Zone 1 tones at phrase endings.

Tiny Tension Arc — The Hook Engine

A **Tiny Tension Arc** is a 3–4 note motif that follows: Zone 1 → Zone 1 → Zone 2 → Zone 1. You establish comfort (Z1), rise to mild tension (Z2), then resolve back. This is the micro-grammar of every catchy melody. Ipanema's opening phrase is a textbook example. **Hear before you play** — sing the arc before touching the instrument.

RHYTHM CHAMBER · SON CLAVE + BOSSA NOVA FEEL

Son Clave 3-2

Son Clave is a two-bar rhythmic pattern that underlies Latin music. In **3-2 orientation**: Bar 1 has 3 hits (beat 1, beat 2-and, beat 3); Bar 2 has 2 hits (beat 1-and, beat 3). The bossa nova guitar and piano rhythms are derived from this pattern — the "and" anticipations you hear in Ipanema come directly from clave positions. **Clap it. Feel it. Then play it.**

Rhythm Code — Positions 2, 4, 6, 8 as Lift

In the 8-position grid (each beat = positions 1-2, each bar of 4 = 8 positions), the **even positions** (2, 4, 6, 8) are the "and" beats — landing here creates lift and forward motion. Bossa nova feel depends on anticipating chord changes and melody notes on these "and" positions rather than waiting for the downbeat.

VOICINGS CHAMBER · DEEPENING INVERSIONS

No new voicing types this sprint — the goal is **voice economy**. Play Fmaj7, Gm7, and C7 using the fewest notes that preserve the quality. Shell voicings (root + 3rd + 7th) are your target. Notice how small movements between chords are possible when you choose inversions wisely. **Sing before you play** — hear the top voice of each chord before your hand moves.



1

SECTION 1 · MUSICAL OS

Plogger Foundation — Ch.5 Lap Map + Ch.6 Fifths

10 min

LAP MAP — IONIAN TETRACHORD FROM F

3 min S1

Hear before you play. Say aloud: "F G A B $\flat$ — tone tone semitone." Place left hand palm-down on lap. Thumb = F, index = G, middle = A, ring = B $\flat$ (the gap between ring and pinky = the half-step). Tap the pattern: thumb, index, middle, ring — speaking "T-T-S" as you tap. Eyes closed. Repeat 4 $\times$. Then do Ionian from C (C D E F). Compare the position of the half-step gap in your hand. Notice: same pattern, different starting finger.

DORIAN TETRACHORD — G A B $\flat$ C

3 min S1

Dorian tetrachord = T-S-T (the half-step sits in the middle). Tap G-A-B $\flat$ -C on your lap: "T — short gap — T." This is the Gm7 tetrachord from Ipanema. Say: "Gm7 comes from G Dorian tetrachord." Now alternate Ionian (F) and Dorian (G) taps, eyes closed — feel the shift in where the compression sits. This finger-feel is the Lap Map in action.

PYTHAGOREAN CHAIN — SPEAK F-C-G-D-A-E-B

4 min S1

Say the chain aloud 3 $\times$: "F – C – G – D – A – E – B." Now say it backwards. Identify where F major sits (far left = one flat). Identify C major (no flats, no sharps — adjacent to F). Ask: what one note changes when moving F $\rightarrow$ C? Answer: B $\flat$ becomes B. Now find G $\flat$ on the chain — it sits opposite F (far right, 6 sharps). This explains the bridge's disorientation: Ipanema doesn't step along the chain, it leaps across it.

2

SECTION 2 · MELODY + RHYTHM + VOICINGS

Integrated Work — Ipanema Materials

18 min

5 KEY NOTES — ANALYZE IPANEMA VERSE

4 min S2

Hear before you play. Listen to (or sing) the first 8 bars of the Ipanema verse. Identify: **First note** (A — the major 3rd of Fmaj7, Zone 1). **Highest note** (D or E — rises to Zone 2 tension on "watch"). **Longest note** — find the held note and name its zone. **Beat-1 notes** — what lands on downbeats? **Last note** of the phrase (resolution — Zone 1?). Write answers in workbook. This is analysis, not playing yet.

TINY TENSION ARC — COMPOSE IN F MAJOR

4 min S2

Sing before you play. Over Fmaj7, Zone 1 = F, A, C (chord tones); Zone 2 = G, B $\flat$, D, E (mild tensions). Compose a 4-note motif: Z1 $\rightarrow$ Z1 $\rightarrow$ Z2 $\rightarrow$ Z1. Example: A – C – D – A. Sing it 3 $\times$ until it's in your ear. Then find it on the guitar (strings 1–3). Play it without looking at your right hand. Add a rhythmic feel: place the Z2 note on an "and" beat for bossa lift.

SON CLAVE 3-2 — CLAP THEN PLAY

4 min S1

Clap first. Bar 1: clap on beat 1, beat 2-and (the "and" of 2), beat 3. Bar 2: clap on beat 1-and, beat 3. Count aloud: "1 — 2 AND 3 — — | — 1 AND — 3 —." Repeat 8 times until it's automatic. Then play open strings on the guitar matching those clap positions. Feel how positions 2, 4, 6, 8 (the "and" beats in the grid) provide the lift. This is the rhythmic DNA of Ipanema.

SHELL VOICINGS — FMAJ7 / GM7 / C7 ON GUITAR

4 min S2

Hear before you play. Play Fmaj7 as a shell voicing (root F on string 4, fret 3 + A on string 3 fret 2 + E on string 1 open or fret 0). Sing the top note before each chord. Move to Gm7: root G string 4 fret 5, B $\flat$ string 3 fret 3, F string 1 fret 1. Then C7: C string 5 fret 3, E string 4 fret 2, B $\flat$ string 2 fret 3. Notice: each chord shares at least one note with the next — find the common tone and let it ring. Voice economy: only change what must change.

CAGED FIRST EXPOSURE — E-FORM AND A-FORM FOR F

2 min S2

F major as E-form barre: barre at fret 1, E-shape behind. F major as A-form: barre fret 1, A-shape (strings 2–4 fret 3). Both are F — same chord, two fingerboard positions. Today: just identify where each sits. Play each once, listen for the difference in register and color. No speed — just map the territory.



3 SECTION 3 · SONG WORK The Girl from Ipanema — Verse Learning

14 min

BOSSA NOVA FINGERPICKING PATTERN — OPEN STRINGS

4 min S1

Hear before you play. Bossa nova fingerpicking: thumb (p) plays bass string on beat 1; then fingers play the treble chord on the "and" beats. Basic pattern: **p – i+a – m – i+a** (thumb on 1, pinch on 1-and, middle on 2-and, pinch on 3-and). On open strings first: p=string 6, i+a=strings 3+1, m=string 2, i+a=strings 3+1. Slow (60 BPM). Count aloud. The thumb alternates strings 6 and 4 once you add chords.

VERSE CHORDS WITH FINGERPICKING — FMAJ7 TO GM7

5 min S2

Play Fmaj7 for 4 bars using the bossa pattern (80 BPM). Thumb alternates string 5 (A) and string 4 (D) for Fmaj7. Then move to G7 for 2 bars — G7 voicing: string 6 fret 3, string 5 fret 2, string 1 fret 1. Then Gm7 to C7 for 2 bars. Keep the fingerpicking pattern consistent through every chord change. **Sing before you play** — sing the chord root on beat 1 before each change. If the pattern breaks, stop, fix the change, restart.

ADD MELODY — IPANEMA OPENING PHRASE

5 min S2

Sing before you play. Sing the first phrase ("Tall and tan and young and lovely...") to lock it in your ear. Locate the melody on strings 1–2: A (fret 5, string 1), then the rising phrase. Play melody-only first at 70 BPM. Then combine: bass note on beat 1 (thumb), melody note where it falls, chord fill on "and" beats where melody rests. This is the classic bossa arrangement approach. Do not rush the combination — melody clarity comes first.

4 SECTION 4 · JAMMING Free Play — Groove + Explore

10 min

JAM PROMPT — IPANEMA VERSE LOOP

10 min S2

Loop the verse chord progression (Fmaj7×4 → G7×2 → Gm7-C7×2) at a comfortable tempo. No pressure to play the melody. Explore: (1) Start with just the bossa pattern, no melody. (2) Add one melody note per bar wherever it feels right. (3) Try stopping the pattern for 1 beat — feel the silence. (4) Try the clave rhythm as a strumming pattern instead of fingerpicking. **The goal: feel the groove, not execute a plan.** If something sounds good, repeat it 8 times.

5 SECTION 5 · THE SYNTHESIZER Connect — Name — Integrate

8 min

WEEK 1 SYNTHESIS — THREE QUESTIONS

8 min S3

Answer aloud or in writing — do not skip this section.

- Plogger** → **Song:** Play the Dorian tetrachord (G A B $\flat$ C) on your lap, then find it on the guitar. Where does it appear in Ipanema's Gm7 section? Sing it over the chord.
- Melody** → **Rhythm:** Your Tiny Tension Arc motif from S2 — play it now with the bossa rhythmic feel, placing the Z2 note on an "and" beat. Does the groove make the tension feel stronger?
- Fifths** → **Song:** G $\flat$ maj7 is the bridge chord. On the Pythagorean chain (F C G D A E B), where is G $\flat$? What does that distance tell you about why the bridge sounds so different from the verse?

SESSION COMPLETE

Guitar Week 1 — 60 minutes

Log your session in the Workbook. Note: what stuck, what needs more time tomorrow.



1

SECTION 1 · MUSICAL OS

Plogger Foundation — Ch.5 Lap Map + Ch.6 Fifths

10 min

LAP MAP — KEYBOARD ON YOUR HAND

3 min S1

Hear before you play. Place left hand palm-down on lap. Tap: thumb (F), index (G), middle (A), ring (B $\flat$) — this is the F Ionian tetrachord. Say: "T-T-S" as you tap. The compression between ring and pinky = half-step. Eyes closed — feel the T-T-S shape as a physical rhythm. Then play this exact tetrachord on the keyboard (F4–G4–A4–B $\flat$ 4, LH thumb on F). Match what your lap told you to what the keys feel like.

F MAJOR HEPTACHORD — LH EYES CLOSED

3 min S1

A heptachord = full 7-note scale. LH: thumb on F3, play F-G-A-B $\flat$ -C-D-E-F4. Say the Longy syllables aloud: "ta te ta te ta te ta." Now eyes closed: play the heptachord ascending and descending without looking. If a note feels wrong, open eyes — identify which step had the wrong interval, re-play that step, close eyes again. Goal: finger-feel, not visual confirmation.

PYTHAGOREAN CHAIN — PLAY ADJACENT KEYS ON PIANO

4 min S1

Say the chain: "F – C – G – D – A – E – B." Play F major scale, then C major scale (LH). What changed? B $\flat$ → B (one note). Play C major, then G major. What changed? F → F $\sharp$. Now play F major, then G $\flat$ major (the bridge key). How many notes changed? Count: 6 of 7 notes are different. Feel that shift in your hand. This is the physical experience of the bridge's disorientation.

2

SECTION 2 · MELODY + RHYTHM + VOICINGS

Integrated Work — Ipanema Materials

18 min

5 KEY NOTES — IPANEMA VERSE ANALYSIS (PIANO)

4 min S2

Hear before you play. Sing the first 8 bars of Ipanema. Find the First note (A4, RH), Highest note (identify it by ear — it's the peak before the phrase descends), Longest note (hold that note on the keyboard, feel which zone it sits in over Fmaj7), Beat-1 notes (what does the melody do on every downbeat?), Last note (where does the phrase land?). Write in workbook. Play only the 5 key notes in sequence — not the full melody — to feel their structure.

TINY TENSION ARC + CHORD TONE IMPROV — F MAJOR Z1

4 min S2

Sing before you play. Zone 1 over Fmaj7 = F, A, C, E (chord tones). Zone 2 = G, B $\flat$, D. Compose a Tiny Tension Arc: Z1 → Z1 → Z2 → Z1. Sing it first (e.g., A–C–D–C). Play it RH only, starting on A4. Vary the rhythm — try placing the Z2 note on beat 2 "and" (bossa lift). LH: hold Fmaj7 shell (F3–A3–E4) sustained. The contrast of stable LH + moving RH arc teaches you melodic composition at the piano.

SON CLAVE 3-2 — TAP THEN PLAY AT PIANO

4 min S1

Clap first. Clave Bar 1: beats 1, 2-and, 3. Bar 2: beats 1-and, 3. Tap on the piano fallboard (lid). Then transfer to keyboard: LH plays low F as a single note on each clave hit. Count: "1 — 2 AND 3 — — | — 1 AND — 3 —." Feel how the "AND" beats pull the rhythm forward. Positions 2, 4, 6, 8 in the 8-position grid are where bossa lives. The clave is the skeleton underneath the beautiful voice.

ALBERTI BASS INTRO + SHELL VOICINGS — PIANO

4 min S2

Hear before you play. Alberti bass = LH pattern: low note → high note → middle note → high note (e.g., over Fmaj7: F3 – C4 – A3 – C4). Play this under a sustained RH A4. Then try shell voicings as block chords: Fmaj7 (F3–A3–E4), Gm7 (G3–B $\flat$ 3–F4), C7 (C3–E3–B $\flat$ 3). Sing the top note of each voicing before playing it. Notice voice economy: the top voice moves F → F → E → B $\flat$ (minimal motion). **Small hand movements = beautiful voice leading.**

BRIDGE PREVIEW — FEEL G $\flat$ MAJOR POSITION

2 min S2

Play G $\flat$ major scale (LH): G $\flat$ A $\flat$ B $\flat$ C $\flat$ D $\flat$ E $\flat$ F G $\flat$. Every note except F is a flat or natural (C $\flat$ =B). Play Fmaj7, then G $\flat$ maj7 (G $\flat$ 3–B $\flat$ 3–F $\flat$ 4 — note F $\flat$ =E). Feel the half-step disorientation. Say: "This is what the bridge feels like to the listener." Then return to Fmaj7 — feel the relief. You just experienced the emotional arc of the song's entire harmonic journey in 2 minutes.



3 SECTION 3 · SONG WORK
The Girl from Ipanema — Verse Learning (Piano)

14 min

RH MELODY — SING + PLAY FIRST PHRASE

4 min S1

Sing before you play. Sing "Tall and tan and young and lovely, the girl from Ipanema goes walking..." until the first phrase is completely in your ear. Then locate: A4 (starting note). Play the melody RH only, very slowly (50 BPM), singing along with every note. Do not look at your fingers — look at the keys, then close your eyes once you know the position. If you lose your place, sing the next note before finding it.

LH CHORD PATTERN UNDER RH MELODY

5 min S2

LH pattern: shell chord held for 2 beats, then root + 5th on beat 3 (a simple 2-beat voicing approach). Fmaj7 bars: LH plays F3-A3-E4 on beat 1, holds. G7 bars: G3-B3-F4. Gm7: G3-B $\flat$ 3-F4. C7: C3-E3-B $\flat$ 3. Add RH melody on top. Start at 60 BPM. The goal is clean coordination, not speed. If hands conflict, practice each hand alone for 30 seconds, then combine. **Hear before you play** — sing the LH chord root before placing your hand.

BOSSA FEEL — ADD RHYTHMIC ANTICIPATION

5 min S2

Bossa nova anticipates the chord on the "and" of beat 4 rather than the downbeat. Instead of playing the G7 chord on beat 1 (bar 5), play it on the "and" of beat 4 (bar 4). This is one anticipation. Practice: play Fmaj7 for 3.5 beats, then G7 on the half-beat before the bar line. Say: "1-2-3-4-AND | (G7 starts here)." This single rhythmic shift makes the piano suddenly sound like a bossa nova recording. Repeat until it feels natural, not rushed.

4 SECTION 4 · JAMMING
Free Play — Groove + Explore (Piano)

10 min

JAM PROMPT — ZONE 1 IMPROV OVER IPANEMA CHANGES

10 min S2

LH holds the verse chord progression as block chords or shells (Fmaj7 $\times$ 4 $\rightarrow$ G7 $\times$ 2 $\rightarrow$ Gm7 $\times$ 1 $\rightarrow$ C7 $\times$ 1). RH improvises using only Zone 1 notes for each chord: over Fmaj7 = F, A, C, E; over G7 = G, B, D, F; over Gm7 = G, B $\flat$, D, F; over C7 = C, E, G, B $\flat$. **Constraint creates creativity.** Stay in Zone 1 for 4 minutes, then allow one Zone 2 note per phrase for the remaining 6 minutes. Notice: Z1 alone sounds beautiful because it's always "right."

5 SECTION 5 · THE SYNTHESIZER
Connect — Name — Integrate

8 min

WEEK 1 SYNTHESIS — THREE QUESTIONS (PIANO)

8 min S3

Answer aloud or in writing — do not skip this section.

1. **Plogger $\rightarrow$ Keyboard:** Play the Dorian tetrachord (G A B $\flat$ C) on your lap, then find it on the piano. Name which chord in Ipanema is built from this tetrachord (Gm7). Sing the tetrachord over the Gm7 chord.
2. **Alberti + Melody:** Play the Alberti bass pattern LH under your Tiny Tension Arc RH. Does the moving LH make the RH feel more alive or more complicated? Name the tradeoff.
3. **G $\flat$ Bridge:** Play F major then G $\flat$ major. Count the notes that changed. Where is G $\flat$ on the Pythagorean chain? Write one sentence: "The bridge sounds dreamlike because..."

SESSION COMPLETE

Piano Week 1 — 60 minutes

Log your session in the Workbook. Note: what clicked, what needs a repeat.

Fill in after each practice session. Honesty > perfection. Short notes are fine.

Week 1 Goals — Set Before Day 1

By end of Week 1, I want to be able to:

The part I'm most uncertain about:

Daily Practice Log — Week 1

DAY	INSTRUMENT	MIN	WHAT CLICKED / WHAT NEEDS WORK	ENERGY (1-5)
1				
2				
3				
4				
5				
6				
7				

Rhythm Log — Clave Practice Tracker

Son Clave 3-2 — mark each time you clap it cleanly for 8 bars straight

Notes on clave feel this week:

5 Key Notes Analysis — Ipanema Verse

KEY NOTE	NOTE NAME	ZONE (Z1 / Z2 / NCT)	WHAT YOU NOTICED
First note			
Last note			
Highest note			
Longest note			
Beat-1 notes			

Song Work Log — Ipanema Progress

SECTION	STATUS	TEMPO ACHIEVED	NOTES
Verse chords only (no melody)	☐ Not started ☐ Drilling ☐ Solid	___ BPM	
Bossa fingerpicking pattern	☐ Not started ☐ Drilling ☐ Solid	___ BPM	
Melody phrase 1 (RH/single notes)	☐ Not started ☐ Drilling ☐ Solid	___ BPM	
Chords + melody combined	☐ Not started ☐ Drilling ☐ Solid	___ BPM	
Bridge recognition by ear	☐ Not started ☐ Drilling ☐ Solid	N/A	

Tiny Tension Arc — Design Your Own

Design a Z1→Z1→Z2→Z1 motif. Name the notes, draw the shape, describe the feel.

Over Fmaj7 (Z1 = F, A, C, E)

Notes: ___ → ___ → ___ → ___

Zones: Z1 → Z1 → Z2 → Z1

Feel:

Over Gm7 (Z1 = G, B $\flat$, D, F)

Notes: ___ → ___ → ___ → ___

Zones: Z1 → Z1 → Z2 → Z1

Feel:

Pythagorean Chain — Fill In From Memory

Fill in the blanks without looking at your notes. Check after.

F

 → → → → → →

Where is G $\flat$ on this chain? Circle or mark it above. How many positions from F?

Weekly Reflection

What landed this week (wins):

What still needs work (honest):

One thing I heard differently in Ipanema after this week:

Synthesizer Check — Week 1

☐ I can explain the Dorian tetrachord shape using my Lap Map, eyes closed

☐ I can state the Pythagorean chain: F–C–G–D–A–E–B without hesitation

☐ I identified all 5 Key Notes in the Ipanema verse

☐ I composed and played at least one Tiny Tension Arc over Fmaj7

☐ I clapped the Son Clave 3-2 pattern cleanly for 8 bars (at least once)

Weeks 2–3 — Concept Progression

WEEK 2

WEEK 3

Each week deepens what you already know. No new major concepts — only sharpened application. Ipanema threads through every section.

WEEK 2 Sharpening — Detail and Speed

S1 — PLOGGER (10 MIN)

Hear before you play. Lap Map: form any major tetrachord from any white-key starting note, eyes closed. Test: F, G, A, B $\flat$, C, D, E — all Ionian (T-T-S). Then test Dorian from G, A, D. Speed goal: each tetrachord < 10 seconds to form on lap. Pythagorean chain: say it forwards and backwards in under 20 seconds. New drill: "What key has 1 flat? 2 flats? 0?" Answer by locating position on chain.

S2 — INTEGRATED (18 MIN)

Melody: Play your Tiny Tension Arc at three rhythmic speeds: quarter notes, then dotted-quarter, then half note on the Z2. Notice how Duration Amplifies Zone — the longer you hold Z2, the stronger the tension. **Sing before you play** every variant. **Rhythm:** Add the clave to your playing. Guitar: clap clave with right hand, then strum on clave hits. Piano: LH plays clave hits as low notes while RH holds chord. **Voicings:** Fmaj7 → Gm7 → C7 → Fmaj7 as voice-led chords. Top voice must move stepwise or stay. Find the smoothest path.

S3 — SONG (14 MIN)

Guitar: Full verse with bossa fingerpicking at 80 BPM. Add melody notes where possible — even if only 3 per bar. The fingerpicking pattern is the priority. Strive for zero hesitation at chord changes. **Piano:** LH anticipations on "and of 4" before each chord change. RH melody clearly audible above the LH texture. Try the full 8-bar verse once at 70 BPM without stopping. **Both:** Listen to the original Ipanema recording. Find your melody in it. Identify the bridge entry by ear.

S4–S5 — JAM + SYNTH (18 MIN)

Jam: Play the verse loop. Add one new element each minute: (1) plain chords, (2) clave rhythm, (3) one melody note per bar, (4) Zone 2 note on "and" beats, (5) a stop — one beat of silence per phrase. 12-bar blues contrast: play I-I-I-I/IV-IV-I-I/V-IV-I-V in F major (F7–B $\flat$ 7–F7–F7/B $\flat$ 7–B $\flat$ 7–F7–F7/C7–B $\flat$ 7–F7–C7). Notice: this is about forward motion, not the spine of all music. **Synth:** "What did the Lap Map teach my body this week that my eyes couldn't?" Write one sentence.

WEEK 3 Bridge — New Harmonic Territory

S1 — PLOGGER (10 MIN)

Hear before you play. Lap Map: now test *black-key starting notes*. G $\flat$ Ionian tetrachord on lap (G $\flat$ A $\flat$ B $\flat$ C $\flat$). The gaps feel different — two black keys in a row means the half-step is between adjacent raised positions. This is G $\flat$ territory. Pythagorean chain: add the flat side — B $\flat$ F C G (going left). State: "F has one flat: B $\flat$. B $\flat$ has two flats: B $\flat$ and E $\flat$." This connects the chain to what you play.

S2 — INTEGRATED (18 MIN)

Sing before you play. 5 Key Notes applied to the *bridge*: "Ooh, but I watch her so sadly..." Find the First, Highest, Longest, Beat-1, Last notes in the bridge phrase. Which zone are they in, over G $\flat$ maj7? Name them. Tiny Tension Arc in G $\flat$ major: compose Z1 → Z1 → Z2 → Z1 over G $\flat$ maj7 (Z1 = G $\flat$, B $\flat$, D $\flat$, F). Sing it. Compare the emotional color to your F major arc — does it feel brighter or more mysterious? Rhythm: play the clave 2-3 orientation (flip bars 1 and 2). Notice how the weight shifts.

S3 — SONG (14 MIN)

Guitar: Learn the bridge chords (G $\flat$ maj7 as barre, B7 as open-position or barre VII, F $\sharp$ m7, D7). Play bridge chord sequence slowly. Connect verse → bridge → back to verse. Feel the shift when you arrive at G $\flat$ — let it be disorienting. That is the *point*. **Piano:** Play verse (LH shell voicings), then bridge (G $\flat$ maj7 position — B $\flat$ 3–D $\flat$ 4–F4 shell). The return to Gm7–C7 at bridge end is the resolution. Play the full AABA form: verse (A) twice, bridge (B), verse (A). At 80 BPM, no stopping.

S4–S5 — JAM + SYNTH (18 MIN)

Jam: Loop the AABA form. Improvise freely on the bridge using only G $\flat$ Ionian chord tones (Z1). Come home to F major on the final A. Notice: how does your body signal "I'm back in F"? That sensation is tonal center awareness. **Synth:** Three questions: (1) How does the Lap Map prepare you for G $\flat$ tetrachords before you touch the instrument? (2) Where in Ipanema does Duration most amplify zone? (3) If you had to explain the bridge to a non-musician, what would you say? Write it out — this builds your musical vocabulary.

Week 4 Rule: Zero new concepts this week. Every exercise is a consolidation of what you learned in Weeks 1–3. The goal is fluency, not new information. If something feels unfamiliar, go back to the Week 1 learning page — don't push forward.



Guitar — Week 4 Goals

- ☐ Full verse + bridge at 100 BPM, bossa fingerpicking clean throughout
- ☐ Melody audible above chord texture, no hesitation at changes
- ☐ Can switch between E-form and A-form F major chord by feel
- ☐ Lap Map: any major/minor tetrachord eyes-closed in <10 sec
- ☐ Pythagorean chain recited in <15 seconds, forwards and backwards
- ☐ Can identify bridge entry (G $\flat$) by ear in recording



Piano — Week 4 Goals

- ☐ Full AABA form (verse-verse-bridge-verse) at 90 BPM
- ☐ LH chord anticipations on "and of 4" feel natural, not calculated
- ☐ Shell voicings for Fmaj7, Gm7, C7, G $\flat$ maj7 from memory
- ☐ Alberti bass pattern clean under sustained RH melody
- ☐ Zone 1 improv over full verse changes, no stumbles
- ☐ Can play F major and G $\flat$ major scales eyes-closed, LH

WEEK 4 JAM PROMPT — BOTH INSTRUMENTS

The Full Journey: AABA at Performance Feel

Hear before you play. Before touching the instrument, close your eyes and hear the entire song — verse, verse, bridge, verse — in your mind at 100 BPM. Hear the bossa groove, the melody arc, the bridge's half-step shift, the return home. Then play it. No metronome. Trust your internal pulse. If you lose the groove, stop — tap the clave — restart from the top of the section.

Minute 1–3: Chords only, groove focus. No melody pressure.

Minute 4–7: Add melody. Keep the groove as the priority.

Minute 8–10: Free — play what feels musical. Stop analyzing.

SYNTHESIZER FULL CIRCUIT — WEEK 4 (8 MIN)

The full synthesis pass — answer each question in order. This is your musical exit interview for Sprint 3.

- Plogger:** Form an F Ionian tetrachord on your lap, then a G Dorian tetrachord. Which chord in Ipanema uses each one? Sing each tetrachord over its chord.
- Melody:** State the 5 Key Notes of Ipanema's verse from memory. Which one surprised you most when you first found it?
- Rhythm:** Clap Son Clave 3-2 for 4 bars. Then play the verse with clave-derived rhythm. Name one place where the clave hits *and* the melody notes align — that's the groove pocket.
- Harmony:** Play Fmaj7 → G $\flat$ maj7. How many notes changed? Where are these keys on the Pythagorean chain? Complete this sentence: "The bridge disorientation works because..."
- Personal:** What is one thing you now *hear* in music that you didn't hear before Sprint 3?

SPRINT 4 PREVIEW — COMING NEXT

Superstition — Stevie Wonder • E $\flat$ Dorian

Plogger: Ch.7–8 Interval Spelling + Ch.9 Di-Chord Numbers intro ([1]–[11] naming)

Melody: Duration Amplifies Zone (deepened) — how held notes reframe everything around them

Rhythm: Progressions 1–4 consolidated. E $\flat$ Dorian groove vs. Ipanema's Ionian feel

Exit Assessment — Sprint 3

END OF SPRINT · SELF-EVALUATE

Complete this after your final Week 4 session. Be honest. This data is your baseline for Sprint 4.

MUSICAL OS — PLOGGER EXIT

- ☐ Lap Map: any major tetrachord eyes-closed from any white key (<10 sec)
- ☐ Lap Map: Dorian tetrachord eyes-closed from G or A
- ☐ Pythagorean chain: F–C–G–D–A–E–B recited without prompts
- ☐ Adjacent keys share 6 of 7 notes — can demonstrate with F → C
- ☐ Can locate G $\flat$ on chain and explain its distance from F

MELODY CHAMBER EXIT

- ☐ 5 Key Notes: can analyze any 8-bar melody for all 5 markers
- ☐ Ipanema verse: can state all 5 key notes from memory
- ☐ Tiny Tension Arc: can compose Z1–Z1–Z2–Z1 in F major, sung first
- ☐ Duration Amplifies Zone: can demonstrate by holding Z2 longer
- ☐ Hear before you play is now a habit, not a reminder

RHYTHM CHAMBER EXIT

- ☐ Son Clave 3-2: clap correctly for 8 bars without counting aloud
- ☐ Rhythm Code positions 2,4,6,8 = "and" beats = lift (can explain)
- ☐ Bossa nova anticipation on "and of 4" feels natural on instrument
- ☐ Can distinguish 3-2 and 2-3 clave by feel (not just by counting)

VOICINGS CHAMBER EXIT

- ☐ Shell voicings: Fmaj7, Gm7, C7, G $\flat$ maj7 from memory
- ☐ Voice economy: top voice moves stepwise between Fmaj7–Gm7–C7
- ☐ Sing before you play top note of each voicing (habit established)
- ☐ Inversions: can choose inversion to minimize hand movement

PERFORMANCE READY CHECK — THE GIRL FROM IPANEMA

Guitar

- ☐ Verse + bridge at 100 BPM, bossa fingerpicking
- ☐ Melody audible, groove maintained
- ☐ Bridge key shift recognized and played with feel

Piano

- ☐ AABA form at 90 BPM, LH anticipations
- ☐ Shell voicings smooth, no positional hesitation
- ☐ G $\flat$ bridge played with half-step disorientation felt

Final Reflection — Sprint 3

What did The Girl from Ipanema teach me about music that I didn't know before?

The Plogger concept that changed how I think:

The melody / rhythm insight I'll carry forward:

One thing I want to explore in Sprint 4 (Superstition) based on what I learned here:

SPRINT 3 COMPLETE

The Girl from Ipanema

AMF · Advanced Music Framework · Sprint 3 of 6